

TIME GRAMMER – 1

Directions for questions 1 to 3: The following sentences have four underlined parts each. One of the underlined parts has an error. Mark, as your answer, the letter corresponding with the underlined part which has an error.

He never has and never will abuse his subordinates even if they disobey his commands.
(A) (B) (C) (D)

☒ a) A (Your answer - ✓)

☐ b) B

☐ c) C

☐ d) D

Show Correct Answer

Hide Solution

PREVIOUS

NEXT

Solution:

There are two auxiliaries 'has' and 'will' here. They can be used only if the form of the verb 'abuse' fits them both. As it should be "abused" for 'has' and 'abuse' for 'will', it is incorrect. The correct form is 'He never has abused and never will abuse - - - - !'
Choice (A)

Directions for questions 1 to 3: The following sentences have four underlined parts each. One of the underlined parts has an error. Mark, as your answer, the letter corresponding with the underlined part which has an error.

What is required are not large amounts of money but generous hearts to donate liberally.
(A) (B) (C) (D)

☐ a) A

☒ b) B (Your answer - ✓)

☐ c) C

☐ d) D

Show Correct Answer

Hide Solution

PREVIOUS

NEXT

Solution:

The structure of the sentence is: What is required is not x but y. Hence the verb should be 'is' not 'are'
Choice (B)

Directions for questions 1 to 3: The following sentences have four underlined parts each. One of the underlined parts has an error. Mark, as your answer, the letter corresponding with the underlined part which has an error.

Every man and every woman were asked to give his or her opinion on the subject without fear or favour.

(A)

(B)

(C)

(D)

☐ a) A

☒ b) B (Your answer - ✓)

☐ c) C

☐ d) D

Show Correct Answer

Hide Solution

PREVIOUS

NEXT

Solution:

'Every man and every woman' should be followed by the singular verb 'was asked'.
Choice (B)

Directions for questions 4 to 6: Identify the incorrect sentence(s).

- a. Africa has a reputation for ferocity.
- b. Tribal wars, genocide and starvation regularly hitting at the head lines.
- c. But there is also another Africa.
- d. The Africa that is young and fresh and full with hope.

☐ a) a and b

☒ b) b and c (Your answer - ✗)

☐ c) a and d

☐ d) b and d

Show Correct Answer

Hide Solution

PREVIOUS

NEXT

Solution:

Statements b and d are incorrect. The correction in b is 'genocide and starvation regularly hit the headlines'. The phrase 'hitting at' means 'to attack violently' which is not suitable in the context.
In d the correction is 'full of hope'.
Choice (D)

Directions for questions 4 to 6: Identify the incorrect sentence(s).

- a. The Shaolin Temple is located in Songshan mountain range.
- b. It was partially burnt in the civil war of the 1920s.
- c. And it was further destroyed by the Japanese in the early 1940s.
- d. The temple was abandoned wreck in 1981.

- ☐ a) a and b
- ☐ b) b and c
- ☐ c) c and d
- ☐ d) a and d

Show Correct Answer

Hide Solution

PREVIOUS

NEXT

Solution:

Statements a and d are incorrect.
The correction in a is 'the Songshan mountain range'. The names of a mountain range should be preceded by the definite article. Hence the correction. The correction in d is 'an abandoned wreck' or 'abandoned a wreck'
Choice (D)

Directions for questions 4 to 6: Identify the incorrect sentence(s).

- a. People are embracing meditation for various reasons.
- b. They stumble across it by chance when trying to manage heart diseases.
- c. It attracted first scientific attention in the US in the late 60s.
- d. Herbert Benson began training heart patients in this technique.

- ☐ a) a and b
- ☐ b) b and c
- ☐ c) a and d

☒ d) c and d (Your answer - ✖)

Show Correct Answer

Hide Solution

PREVIOUS

NEXT

Solution:

In b, the phrase 'stumble across something' means 'to discover accidentally'. Hence the words 'by chance' are redundant. The correction in c is 'It first attracted scientific attention - - -'. The words 'first scientific attention' make no sense. Hence the correction.
Choice (B)

Directions for questions 7 and 8: Identify the correct sentence(s).

- a. Experts believe that future belongs to the fuel cell.
- b. It draws of hydrogen to produce energy for the electric drive system.
- c. American and Japanese developers have made impressive progress in this direction.
- d. In five to eight years, all the leading manufacturers intend to be on the market with fuel-cell cars.

☐ a) b and c

☒ b) a and d (Your answer - ✖)

☐ c) c and d

☐ d) Only c

Show Correct Answer

Hide Solution

PREVIOUS

NEXT

Solution:

Statement c is grammatically correct. a and b are incorrect. Statement a should take 'the future'. We always say 'the past', 'the present' and 'the future'. Statement b is erroneous because 'draws of' makes no sense in the context. The appropriate phrasal verb is 'draws on' which means 'make use of'. Statement d should have 'in the market'.
Choice (D)

Directions for questions 7 and 8: Identify the correct sentence(s).

- a. Biology tells that our closest relatives are the primate apes.
- b. The family line between them and us branched only few million years ago.
- c. The DNA, or the molecular genetic heritage, of the chimpanzee is about 98 per cent similar to us.
- d. A mere 2 per cent of the genetic provenance distinguishes us from them.

☐ a) a and b

☐ b) b and c

☐ c) a, b and c

☐ d) Only d

Show Correct Answer

Hide Solution

PREVIOUS

NEXT

Solution:

Statement a is incorrect because 'tells' is a transitive verb which requires an object after it. Hence the correction is "biology tells us". The second statement (b) is incorrect because of the absence of article 'a' before few. Hence the correction is 'a few' which means 'some'. The correction in statement c is 'similar to ours'. The comparison is between genetic heritage of the chimpanzee and that of the human beings. Hence it takes 'ours'.
Choice (D)

Direction for question 9 to 12: In each of the following sentences, a part of the sentence is underlined. Beneath each sentence, four different ways of phrasing the underlined part are indicated. Choose the best alternative and mark the letter corresponding with it as your answer.

Self-awareness is not a state that is effaced from emotions, overreacting and amplifying what one is perceiving, rather, it is the neutral mode that maintains self-reflectiveness even amidst turbulent emotions.

☐ a) effaced from emotions, overreacting and amplifying what one is perceiving, rather, it is the neutral mode

☒ b) effaced by emotions, overreacting and amplifying what one is perceiving, rather, it a neutral mode (Your answer - ✖)

☐ c) effaced out by emotions, overreacting and amplifying what one perceives, rather it is a neutral mode

☐ d) effaced by emotions, overreacting and amplifying what one perceives, rather, it is a neutral mode

Solution:

The underlined part is incorrect because 'effaced' should be followed by 'by' and not by 'from'. The idea intended is that self-awareness is not a state that is effected (wiped out) by emotions or any other disorderly state. Hence 'effaced by emotions' is correct. Besides, 'what one is perceiving' is an incorrect expression. 'Perceive' is a verb of perception, hence it cannot take the continuous form. Hence 'what one perceives' is correct. The words 'it is the neutral mode' are incorrect. We are referring to a state hence 'a neutral mode' is correct.
Choice (D)

Direction for question 9 to 12: In each of the following sentences, a part of the sentence is underlined. Beneath each sentence, four different ways of phrasing the underlined part are indicated. Choose the best alternative and mark the letter corresponding with it as your answer.

With the new airport coming up in this area the property is ideally located with all local amenities closed in hand.

☐ a) is ideally located with all local amenities close at hand

☒ b) with all local amenities is ideally located at close hand (Your answer - ✖)

☐ c) is close at hand with all local amenities ideally located

☐ d) is at close hand with all local amenities ideally located

Show Correct Answer

Hide Solution

PREVIOUS

NEXT

Solution:

The phrase 'close at hand' means nearby and qualifies 'local amenities'; hence it should be placed near the noun it qualifies. Only choice (A) is appropriate 'at close hand' makes choices (B) and (D) wrong. Choice (C) is wrong because the 'local amenities' are not ideally located but the property that is 'ideally located'

Choice (A)

Direction for question 9 to 12: In each of the following sentences, a part of the sentence is underlined. Beneath each sentence, four different ways of phrasing the underlined part are indicated. Choose the best alternative and mark the letter corresponding with it as your answer.

Yesterday I met the man who, you said, you gave my book.

☐ a) who, you said, you gave my book

☐ b) who, you said, you gave my book, to

☐ c) who you had been saying you gave my book

☒ d) to whom, you said, you gave my book (Your answer - ✔)

Direction for question 9 to 12: In each of the following sentences, a part of the sentence is underlined. Beneath each sentence, four different ways of phrasing the underlined part are indicated. Choose the best alternative and mark the letter corresponding with it as your answer.

Despite exile, imprisonment and the suppression of almost everyone of his books by the minions of Church and state; Voltaire forged fiercely a path for his truth, until at last, kings, Popes and emperors catered to him, thrones trembled before him and half the world would be listening to catch his every word.

- ☐ a) half the world would be listening to catch his every word
- ☐ b) half the world listened to catch his every word
- ☐ c) half the world have been listening to catch his every word

☒ d) half the world had listened to catch his every word (Your answer - ✕)

Show Correct Answer

Hide Solution

PREVIOUS

NEXT

Solution:

The tense in all the choices, except (B) is wrong. The sentence is in the past tense and only choice (B) sticks to it.
Choice (B)

Directions for questions 13 to 15: Select as your answer the correct words, from the choices, that complete the given sentences. Please note that more than one choice may fit in but select the choice that is logical in the context of the sentence.

It is an image that will ____ to come.

- ☐ a) haunt relations with India and Bangladesh for years
- ☐ b) severe relations between India and Bangladesh in years
- ☐ c) haunt relations between India and Bangladesh for years
- ☐ d) severe relations between India and Bangladesh for years

Show Correct Answer

Hide Solution

PREVIOUS

NEXT

Solution:

An image cannot 'severe' relations between two countries. Hence we rule out (B) and (D). Between (A) and (C), the relation is 'between' the two countries and not 'with'.
Choice (C)

Directions for questions 13 to 15: Select as your answer the correct words, from the choices, that complete the given sentences. Please note that more than one choice may fit in but select the choice that is logical in the context of the sentence.

Gujarat will forever remember January 26 as the day the earth heaved and ____.

- ☐ a) left in its wake grieving families
- ☐ b) left in its wake grievous families
- ☐ c) left on its wake grieving families
- ☐ d) caused the greatest earthquake the country will ever know

Show Correct Answer

Hide Solution

PREVIOUS

NEXT

Solution:

The given sentence says 'the earth heaved' which means that there was an earthquake. So to say 'it caused the greatest earthquake' (choice D) is redundant. We are looking for the result of the earthquake. A, B and C state the result but only A is grammatically right.
Choice (A)

Directions for questions 13 to 15: Select as your answer the correct words, from the choices, that complete the given sentences. Please note that more than one choice may fit in but select the choice that is logical in the context of the sentence.

One of India's continuing tragedies has been ____ and what may be called "Organisational apital".

- ☐ a) their failing to learn the importance of coordination
- ☐ b) its failure to learn the importance of coordination
- ☐ c) their failure to learn the magnanimity of coordination
- ☐ d) its failure to learn the magnanimity of coordination

Show Correct Answer

Hide Solution

PREVIOUS

NEXT

Solution:

We are talking of India's tragedies, so the pronoun is singular (its) not plural (theirs). A and C are ruled out. Between B and D 'the importance of coordination' is more appropriate than 'magnanimity of coordination' (what magnanimity is there in coordination?).
Choice (B)